

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.33

UTILI0.43

TECHN0.62

COMM.0.75

ENERG0.86

FINAN0.90

CONS.1.25

CONS.1.40

HEALT2.58

INDUS7.69

MATER49.98

1

AMZN

BUY

\$268.76

+0.56%

8/10

The everything company is now the AI cloud + logistics + advertising c

2

NVDA

BUY

\$225.41

+0.59%

8/10

NVDA is the toll booth on the AI buildout — and now Wall Street is lit

3

GOOGL

BUY

\$345.29

+0.51%

8/10

Alphabet is emerging as the vertically-integrated AI winner — owns the

Big options bets on EOG (Other) — 10.9x normal volume, P/C 0.13, largest: PUT \$146 (9.6x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP	FED & ECONOMY TODAY	SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?
No major earnings this week	CPI Date: 2026-08-13 HIGH VIX at 14.4 — low. Options market complacent ahead of scheduled events. PPI [HIGH] CPI [HIGH]	No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: in demand · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Here's what's interesting: the biggest bullish bets are piling into Real Estate and Utilities — the two most interest-rate-sensitive sectors on the board — which tells me big money is positioning for rate cuts or at least a Fed that's done hiking, and it lines up with the bond market too (LQD, investment-grade bonds, is flashing bullish).

Tech is quietly bid as well, which fits the "soft landing plus AI capex" narrative, and there's likely an assumption that whatever tax and deregulation talk is floating around Washington keeps the mega-cap growth trade alive.

On the flip side, the aggressive hedging in Materials (that 49x put/call is genuinely wild) and Industrials suggests smart money is bracing for tariff blowback, a China slowdown, or the reality that infrastructure spending is peaking — basically, they don't believe the "reflation" story the cyclicals have been telling.

Healthcare getting sold hard is almost certainly about drug pricing pressure, Medicare negotiation expansion, and election-year political risk that nobody wants to own into headlines.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.91/100
Leidos combines a defensive government-services backlog with grow			
2.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	8.91/100
SMCI is the leading builder of AI-optimized servers and liquid-co			
3.	MDB	MongoDB, Inc.	8.46/100
MongoDB's document database and Atlas Vector Search are becoming			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 7/10
Pages 19–20	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 21–22	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 5/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy	\$303.89 ▲ 0.54%	12M Price Target \$340.00	52-Week Range \$223.78 – \$344.57	Market Cap \$4.44T
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AAPL: Siri AI Reboot Meets China Tariff Overhang

WHAT HAPPENED

- Apple's reportedly cutting checks to publishers to feed a smarter Siri — this is the story to watch. It signals Apple is finally admitting it can't build a competitive AI in-house from scratch, so it's licensing content the way OpenAI did. Translation: they're spending money to catch up, but they're also protecting the crown jewel (1B+ iPhone users) from getting siphoned off by ChatGPT and Gemini.
- Stock is down ~3% off last week's high (\$313 → \$304) on no company-specific bad news — that's a market breather, not a break. Volume today is unusually light (7M vs. 40M normal), so don't over-read the tape.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Siri-publisher deal tells you Apple's AI strategy is shifting from "we'll do it ourselves" to "we'll pay to plug in the best stuff" — that's expensive short-term but probably the right call, because every quarter Siri stays dumb, Google's Gemini (now shipping on Pixel 11) eats mindshare. Here's the inference: if Apple can turn iPhone 17/18 into a genuinely useful AI device by holiday '26, you get a real upgrade cycle — the first one in years — and that's what justifies the current ~40x P/E (meaning investors are paying \$40 for every \$1 of annual earnings). The bearish read is that Apple is now paying for something competitors get from scraping the web for free, so margins take a hit. Watch for Foxconn's 35% profit jump — that's a leading indicator that iPhone build orders are strong going into the fall launch.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things on the political radar: (1) Trump-era tariffs on Chinese electronics — Apple got selective exemptions before, but every renegotiation is a cliffhanger since roughly 80% of iPhones are still assembled in China/India. Any escalation is an instant margin hit. (2) The DOJ antitrust case against Google — Apple gets ~\$20B/year from Google to be the default iPhone search engine, and that's basically 100% margin. If a judge forces that payment to end, it's a real earnings hit (~5-7% of net income). Also worth watching: the EU Digital Markets Act enforcement actions on App Store fees — that pressure is only growing.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$304 and ~\$4.4T market cap, you're paying about 41x forward earnings — meaning \$41 for every \$1 of profit Apple will make next year. That's rich for a company growing revenue in the mid-single digits, but the market pays up because Apple prints ~\$100B in free cash flow annually and buys back stock like it's their job. Fair? Barely. But there's no cheap entry here unless the whole market pukes — this is a "own it, don't trade it" stock.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$303.89
12M Price Target	\$340.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.9%
Market Cap	\$4.44T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.35
FY2027E EPS	\$8.10
Fwd P/E	41.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$320.00	\$308.00	\$285.00
6 Months	\$355.00	\$325.00	\$270.00
1 Year	\$385.00	\$340.00	\$255.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$380.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$260.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+2.9% over 5 days) and Comm Services are leading — money is flowing back to mega-cap growth as rate cut expectations firm up. Real Estate popping today likely a rate-sensitivity trade.

COOLING OFF: Financials and Utilities are lagging on a relative basis — classic risk-on rotation signal.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO AI-adjacent names but AWAY from the pure hardware story. Apple straddles both, which is why it's underperforming Nvidia/MSFT this month — it's not "AI enough" for the momentum crowd yet.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the Apple AI story, Foxconn (assembly) and TSMC (chips) are the picks-and-shovels plays. Foxconn's 35% profit jump today is basically an Apple leading indicator.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI king — every AI capex dollar flows through their GPUs first.
- MSFT (Microsoft): Copilot monetization is finally showing up in numbers, and Azure AI is winning enterprise deals.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is LAGGING the mega-cap AI cohort right now — down while the sector is up 3% on the week. That tells you the market wants proof Apple has a real AI story before rewarding it. September iPhone event is the show-me moment.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Cautiously bullish. This isn't a moonshot, it's a "own quality, sleep well" position with a real catalyst (September event) in front of it.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio. Big enough to matter, small enough that a tariff headline doesn't ruin your week.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on dips to \$295-302. If we get a macro flush to \$280, load up — you're getting a franchise business at a discount.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst path: September iPhone event → holiday sales data → Siri AI rollout in early 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: iPhone unit sales down more than 8% YoY, or a court forces the Google search payment to end without a replacement, or China tariffs jump above 25% on electronics with no exemption.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — pair this with some cash or a small position in gold/treasuries for the tariff tail risk. If you're comfortable with options, buying cheap out-of-the-money puts 6 months out costs you a rounding error and protects against the "Taiwan headline" nightmare scenario.

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$175.66 ▲ 2.70%	12M Price Target \$185.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$422.13B
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PLTR: AI Defense Darling Priced for Perfection

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR popped 2.7% to \$175.66 on notably light volume (5.6M vs the usual 40-80M) — that thin tape tells me this is a drift higher on no real news, not conviction buying. The tech sector was up ~1% broadly, so PLTR just rode the wave.
- Ondas (a PLTR-backed drone company) reported revenue up 1,236% but wider losses — this is a sideshow but reinforces the "Palantir ecosystem" narrative that keeps retail excited.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm actually thinking: the options market is bullish (put/call ratio 0.84, meaning traders are buying more upside bets than downside protection), but insiders — specifically CTO Shyam Sankar — are selling, which is a yellow flag when the stock is near 52-week highs. When smart money on the inside is trimming while retail piles into leveraged ETFs like PLTU (2x leveraged Palantir), that's usually late-cycle behavior. The Michael Burry "1987-style crash" headlines circulating today aren't PLTR-specific, but PLTR is exactly the kind of high-multiple momentum name that gets hit hardest in any risk-off event. Bottom line: the fundamentals are still great, but you're paying a premium price at a moment when the setup is fragile.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch: the FY2027 defense appropriations debate ramping up in Congress this fall — PLTR's Maven Smart System contract with the Army was expanded to \$1.3B+ and any DoD budget top-line increase directly feeds their pipeline. The Trump administration's continued push on "AI for government efficiency" (DOGE-style initiatives) is a clear tailwind since PLTR is the incumbent vendor for federal data integration. The wildcard is potential export control tightening on AI software to allies — if new rules restrict who PLTR can sell to internationally, their commercial growth story (currently the hotter segment) takes a hit.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

This is where it gets uncomfortable — PLTR trades around 244x forward earnings, meaning you're paying \$244 for every \$1 of profit the company will make next year. For context, Microsoft trades around 35x and even Nvidia is around 40x. The only way this math works is if revenue keeps compounding 30%+ for years AND margins keep expanding — the business is delivering that right now, but there's zero room for a miss.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$175.66
12M Price Target	\$185.00
Upside / (Downside)	+5.3%
Market Cap	\$422.13B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,800M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.72
FY2027E EPS	\$1.05
Fwd P/E	244.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$195.00	\$178.00	\$158.00
6 Months	\$220.00	\$185.00	\$140.00
1 Year	\$250.00	\$195.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$230.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$320.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$500.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+2.9% over 5 days) is leading again, driven by AI capex momentum and continued government AI spending signals. Real Estate and Comm Services are catching a bid on rate-cut expectations.

COOLING OFF: Nothing is truly cooling today — everything's green — but Financials at just +0.3% is a tell that risk appetite is narrowing to tech/AI rather than broad-based.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing into AI infrastructure and defense-tech names, which is exactly PLTR's sweet spot — but the light volume today suggests this is being driven by systematic/passive flows rather than active conviction.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the PLTR thesis but hate the multiple, look at defense primes like Lockheed or Raytheon that benefit from the same budget tailwind at a fraction of the P/E. Data center/power names (VST, CEG) also benefit from the AI compute buildout.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Broke out today per IBD — Azure AI revenue and government cloud contracts are humming, which validates the broader "AI-for-enterprise-and-government" thesis PLTR rides.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Continues to set the tone for AI sentiment; when NVDA is bid, PLTR gets bid.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is at 69% of its 52-week range, meaning it's closer to highs than lows but not extended like some peers. It's participating in the AI rally but not leading it today — that's actually a healthy sign, but the low volume tells me buyers aren't aggressive here. Watch if PLTR can reclaim \$180 on real volume; if not, we drift.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I love the business, I'm nervous about the price and the late-cycle vibes (insider selling, leveraged ETF launches, "buy the dip in a crash" headlines).

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% — this is a "own some, don't overdo it" name. The upside is real but a 30% drawdown wouldn't surprise me at all.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd rather add at \$150-160 on a macro fear day than chase at \$175. If it breaks \$200 on strong volume with a clear catalyst (like a defense bill signing), that changes the setup.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the key catalyst being FY27 defense appropriations and continued commercial revenue acceleration into Q4.

WHEN TO BAIL: Two consecutive quarters where commercial revenue growth decelerates below 30%, OR a meaningful defense budget cut, OR the stock breaks and holds below \$140 (which would tell me the trend is broken).

HEDGING: Simplest approach — if you own 100 shares, buy 1 protective put option 10-15% out of the money expiring in 3-6 months. Think of it as insurance: it costs a small premium, but caps your downside if the market pukes. Alternatively, trim 25% of your position if it rips to \$200+ and reload lower.

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy

\$268.76 ▲ 0.56%

12M Price Target
\$315.00

52-Week Range
\$196.00 – \$287.20

Market Cap
\$2.90T

AMZN: Consolidating Near Highs as AWS + Retail Both Firing

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat (+0.56%) after a two-day pullback from \$278 — this looks like normal profit-taking near the 52-week high, not a fundamental shift. Volume today is unusually light (4.2M vs the typical 30M+), which tells me it's a quiet summer trading day with most institutions on the sidelines, not real selling pressure.
- Bezos dumped \$346M in stock on Aug 3 — but before you panic, this is part of his pre-scheduled 10b5-1 plan (systematic selling he announces in advance). It's not a signal he thinks the stock is topy; it's diversification. Still, insider signal reads bearish on paper.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm actually reading: options traders are leaning bullish (put/call at 0.67 means way more call buyers betting on upside than put buyers hedging downside), AND we're seeing huge unusual call buying at the \$205 strike — that's deep in-the-money, which usually means an institution is building a synthetic long position cheaply rather than a speculative bet. Translation: big money is quietly accumulating. The stock sitting at 80% of its 52-week range with tech sector up 2.9% over 5 days tells me AMZN is consolidating, not rolling over — it's digesting gains while the sector leads. The bigger picture: AWS is the pick-and-shovel play for the AI boom, and every enterprise AI dollar spent in the next 24 months has to touch a hyperscaler cloud.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to watch: (1) The FTC's antitrust case against Amazon is still grinding through the courts — a Trump-era FTC is generally seen as less aggressive on Big Tech breakups than Khan's FTC was, which is a quiet tailwind that isn't priced in. (2) Federal AI procurement is accelerating — the government is signing multi-billion cloud contracts and AWS's GovCloud is the incumbent for classified workloads, so any expansion of federal AI spending flows disproportionately to Amazon. Tariff risk cuts the other way: continued China tariff escalation raises retail COGS (cost of goods sold — what Amazon pays for inventory) and could pressure the North America retail margin.

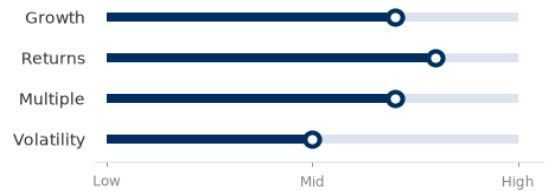
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$269 and roughly 39x forward earnings, you're paying \$39 for every \$1 of next year's profit — that sounds expensive, but AWS alone is growing ~18-20% with 35%+ operating margins, and advertising (Amazon's hidden gem) is a \$60B+ business growing 20%+. Strip those out and the retail business is basically free at these prices. It's not a bargain, but it's fairly valued for a company with three double-digit growth engines and improving free cash flow.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$268.76
12M Price Target	\$315.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.2%
Market Cap	\$2.90T
FY2026E Revenue	\$460M
FY2027E Revenue	\$510M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.80
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	39.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$285.00	\$275.00	\$258.00
6 Months	\$315.00	\$295.00	\$245.00
1 Year	\$345.00	\$315.00	\$230.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$355.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$450.00	\$280.00
10 Years	\$850.00	\$650.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+2.9% over 5 days) is leading — AI infrastructure spend and Fed rate-cut expectations are the fuel. Real Estate and Comm Services also perking up, suggesting rate-sensitive names are catching a bid.

COOLING OFF: Financials lagging (+0.5% over 5D) — a sign the market thinks rate cuts are coming, which pressures bank net interest margins.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO mega-cap tech as investors position for a September Fed cut. That's a direct tailwind for AMZN since lower rates boost the present value of its future cash flows.

RELATED PLAY: If you like AMZN's AWS story, the second-derivative plays are data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) and power infrastructure (VST, CEG) — Amazon's capex has to go somewhere, and it's flowing to power and colocation.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- **GOOGL (Alphabet):** Winning retail investor sentiment for next 12 months per today's Stocktwits data — Gemini's AI momentum is closing the gap with AWS/Azure.
- **META (Meta Platforms):** Wall Street's top upside pick — ad market strength and AI-driven ad targeting improvements are boosting analyst confidence.

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is holding its own but not leading the mega-cap pack — it's a coiled spring rather than a rocket. That's actually fine; it means expectations aren't stretched and there's room for upside surprise on the next AWS print.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Three growth engines, improving profitability, and a friendlier regulatory backdrop. Not pounding the table because valuation isn't cheap, but this is a core hold.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% — big enough to matter, small enough that a 20% drawdown doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on any dip to \$260 and back up the truck under \$250. Chasing at \$278+ is where you get impatient and pay too much.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is Q3 earnings in late October — specifically AWS growth rate and 2027 capex guidance.

WHEN TO BAIL: AWS growth prints below 15% YoY two quarters in a row, or the FTC case suddenly gets teeth (unlikely under current admin, but watch it).

HEDGING: Buy a put option 10-15% below current price as insurance — think of it like collision coverage on your car. Costs a bit, but protects you from a nasty tech-wide selloff.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Buy	\$143.42 ▼ 1.87%	12M Price Target \$165.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.89T
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SPCX: Space ETF Cools After SpaceX-Driven Rally

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX pulled back 1.87% after yesterday's ~10% pop to \$146. Volume today is way lighter (20M vs 166M yesterday) — that's not real selling pressure, that's just people catching their breath after a big move. Translation: profit-taking, not a trend change.
- The news flow is actually bullish — Morgan Stanley's Adam Jonas (basically the SpaceX bull on Wall Street) put out a long-term bullish note, and there's chatter about SpaceX pushing into AI via Grok. SpaceX is the biggest weight in this ETF, so what moves SpaceX moves SPCX.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what today really means: the market is treating SPCX like a SpaceX proxy, and that's mostly right — SpaceX (through private share exposure) plus Rocket Lab, Planet Labs, and Iridium drive most of the moves. The pullback is healthy after a violent one-day rally, and the fact that puts flow is heavy at the \$200 strike tells me big money is positioning for a much higher move over the next few months (they're buying insurance because they own the stock, not shorting it). Bigger picture: we're in the middle of the largest peacetime space buildout in U.S. history, and SPCX is the cleanest ETF way to play it without picking a single winner. The pullback is a gift if you don't own it yet.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The single most important policy driver right now is the "Golden Dome" missile defense initiative — the Trump administration's Iron Dome-for-America project, which is projected to funnel \$175B+ into space-based sensors, satellites, and interceptors over the next decade. SpaceX, L3Harris, and Rocket Lab (all SPCX holdings) are frontrunners for contracts. Also watch the FY2027 defense authorization bill working through Congress — Space Force's budget is expected to grow another 15-20%, and the FCC's proposed spectrum rules for low-earth-orbit satellites could either accelerate or bottleneck Starlink competitors. Net-net: policy tailwind is as strong as it's been in a decade.

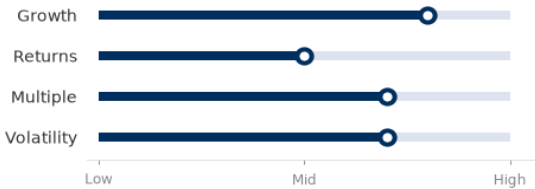
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

SPCX is trading at roughly 32% of its 52-week range (\$104-\$225), so despite the SpaceX-driven optimism it's actually closer to the low end than the high — meaning you're not chasing a top here. The underlying holdings trade at a premium (investors are paying up because space is a "story stock" sector where growth beats profits right now), but if Golden Dome contracts start hitting in 2026-2027, today's multiples will look cheap in hindsight. Fair value in my base case is \$160-170 over the next 12 months.

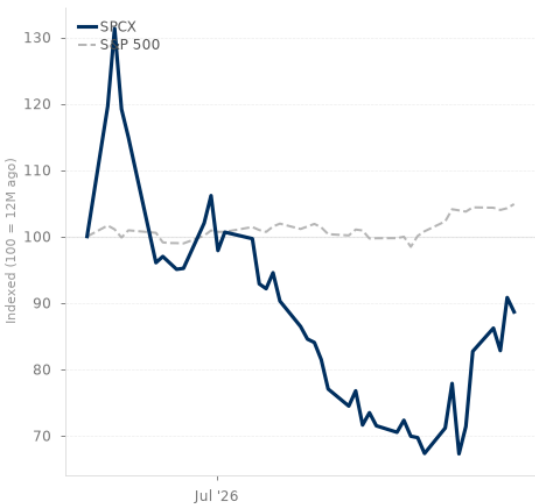
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$143.42
12M Price Target	\$165.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.0%
Market Cap	\$1.89T
FY2026E Revenue	\$693M
FY2027E Revenue	\$940M
FY2026E EPS	(\$2.10)
FY2027E EPS	(\$1.50)
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$155.00	\$145.00	\$130.00
6 Months	\$180.00	\$160.00	\$125.00
1 Year	\$210.00	\$165.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$260.00	\$195.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$400.00	\$275.00	\$130.00
10 Years	\$650.00	\$425.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+2.91% 5D) and Communications — both benefit from the same AI/space/data infrastructure wave that lifts SPCX. Real Estate leading today is a rate-cut bet, which also helps capital-intensive space names.

COOLING OFF: Energy and materials are quiet — the market is prioritizing growth stories over cyclical right now.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving into "hard tech" — space, defense, AI infrastructure — because these are the sectors with direct government spending tailwinds. That's the SPCX bull case in one sentence.

RELATED PLAY: If SPCX runs, watch ITA (defense ETF) and the pure-play satellite comms names like Iridium — they're the second-order beneficiaries of the same Golden Dome dollars.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Winning the medium-lift launch race and picking up Space Force contracts SpaceX doesn't want.
- LHX (L3Harris): Space-based sensor supplier that's directly tied to Golden Dome architecture wins.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is leading its historical peer set because SpaceX exposure is unique — no other ETF offers this. That premium should persist as long as private SpaceX marks keep rising.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the policy setup and the SpaceX flywheel, but valuation isn't screaming cheap and the ETF can whipsaw hard on any SpaceX news.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — enough to matter if it works, small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$133-138 (recent support). Today's dip toward \$143 is a nibble, not a back-up-the-truck moment.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is Golden Dome contract awards starting to hit the tape in late 2026 / early 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Golden Dome funding gets cut in half in appropriations, or if SPCX breaks below \$120 on heavy volume — that tells me the thesis is broken, not just noisy.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is just to size smaller. If you want to get fancy, buy a small amount of downside puts 3-6 months out — think of it like buying insurance on your house, small cost for peace of mind.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Buy	\$99.61 ▲ 4.95%	12M Price Target \$115.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$89.55B
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HOOD: Tokenization Bet Sparks 5% Pop, Crypto Rules Loom

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD popped nearly 5% on unusually light volume (~4M shares vs the usual 12-14M) — that's a "nobody wanted to sell" move, not a "everyone's piling in" move, which often signals sticky buyers. The narrative catalyst: multiple pieces landing on tokenization (basically putting stocks and real assets on a blockchain) and Robinhood's "10x business" — meaning analysts are looking past the crypto trading slowdown to newer revenue lines.
- Bloomberg's "Crypto's Wall Street Era" piece matters because it signals institutional money is taking over from retail — that's a headwind for HOOD's crypto trading fees short-term, but a tailwind if they successfully pivot to being infrastructure (custody, tokenization rails) rather than just a retail casino.

WHY IT MATTERS

The market is starting to re-rate HOOD from "meme-stock broker" to "digital finance platform" — and that's a much higher-multiple business. The tokenization angle is the real story: if HOOD becomes a place where you can trade tokenized versions of private companies (SpaceX, Stripe, OpenAI), that unlocks a market retail investors have literally never had access to. The light-volume rally suggests conviction holders aren't selling into strength, which typically precedes another leg up. What to watch: whether the "crypto slump" narrative starts weighing on Q3 numbers before the new products can offset it — that's the gap risk.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one is the CLARITY Act and follow-on crypto market structure legislation — the framework that finally tells crypto exchanges which coins are securities (SEC's turf) vs commodities (CFTC's turf). If it passes with tokenized equities getting a clear green light, HOOD's EU tokenization launch becomes a template for a US rollout worth billions. Separately, watch the CFTC's stance on prediction markets (HOOD owns Kalshi-competitor infrastructure via its event contracts) — the current administration has been notably friendlier to these products than the previous one, which is a direct tailwind.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$100, you're paying roughly 21x forward revenue and ~54x forward earnings — that's expensive for a broker (Schwab trades at ~18x earnings), but cheap if you believe HOOD is really a fintech platform (Coinbase trades at similar or richer multiples). The bull case says the tokenization + prediction markets + retirement accounts businesses justify a premium because they open totally new revenue pools; the bear case says trading revenue is cyclical and you're paying peak multiples on peak earnings.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-13 14:03 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$99.61
12M Price Target	\$115.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.5%
Market Cap	\$89.55B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	53.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$110.00	\$102.00	\$88.00
6 Months	\$130.00	\$110.00	\$80.00
1 Year	\$155.00	\$115.00	\$70.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$140.00	\$60.00
5 Years	\$320.00	\$200.00	\$50.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$275.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+2.9% over 5 days) and Comm Services — money is chasing anything AI-adjacent and platform-y. Real Estate leading today is a rate-cut trade, which also indirectly helps HOOD (more risk appetite = more trading).

COOLING OFF: Pure-play crypto exchanges are losing retail buzz per Bloomberg — the "easy money" phase of the crypto cycle is done, institutions are taking over.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from speculative crypto plays into "picks and shovels" fintech that can monetize crypto AND traditional assets — that's exactly where HOOD is positioning itself, hence the outperformance vs COIN.

RELATED PLAY: If tokenization takes off, the custody and blockchain infrastructure names benefit too — think COIN (despite competition) and the stablecoin issuers. Also CME as prediction markets grow.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- COIN (Coinbase): Also benefits from crypto regulation clarity, but more exposed to the retail slowdown Bloomberg flagged.
- SCHW (Charles Schwab): The "boring" comp — HOOD is essentially trying to become Schwab-with-crypto-and-tokenization, which is why the multiple gap matters.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is leading its peer group today — a 5% pop while Financials sector is up just 0.34% tells you this is company-specific enthusiasm, not sector beta. That's bullish because it means the market is singling HOOD out for its unique positioning, not just riding a wave.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the strategic pivot but the stock isn't cheap and near-term crypto softness is real; I'm optimistic, not pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — enough to matter if the tokenization thesis plays out, small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd rather add on pullbacks to \$90-95 than chase this rip. The options flow (Put/Call 0.26, heavy call buying) says traders expect more upside, but disciplined entries win over time.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — waiting for the crypto legislation catalyst and US tokenization launch. Both should hit in that window.

WHEN TO BAIL: If crypto revenue drops 30%+ two quarters running with no tokenization traction, or if the CLARITY Act dies in committee, thesis is broken — take the L and move on.

HEDGING: Simplest move — buy a put option (insurance that pays if the stock drops) around the \$85 strike a few months out. Costs a bit but caps your downside if the crypto slump hits before new products ramp.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy

\$588.05 ▲ 1.59%

12M Price Target
\$720.00

52-Week Range
\$520.26 – \$796.25

Market Cap
\$1.50T

META: AI Spend Under Fire, But Ad Engine Still Humming

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock bounced 1.6% today after yesterday's 3.4% drop — classic dead-cat bounce or real dip-buying? I lean dip-buying, because the news flow is actually constructive: Wall Street analysts are still calling META the top upside pick in mega-cap tech per that Stocktwits piece, even though retail prefers GOOGL.
- Two things are pressuring the stock though: (1) Meta launched a \$1B fund specifically to smooth over community pushback on AI data centers — that's a "we have a problem" signal, and (2) they nuked 756k Australian teen accounts as regulators tighten the screws on youth safety. Both cost money and hint at more compliance drag coming.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: META is stuck at 25% of its 52-week range (\$588 vs a \$796 high) because the market can't decide if the massive AI capex is genius or reckless. The \$1B community fund for data centers tells you the physical AI buildout is hitting real-world friction — zoning fights, water usage complaints, power grid concerns — and that could slow their AI roadmap by quarters, not years. But here's the flip side nobody's pricing in: if the Trump administration's AI infrastructure push (which favors domestic buildout and streamlined permitting) actually delivers, META's early capex bet becomes a moat that smaller competitors literally can't replicate. The insider selling from COO Olivan is small and looks like planned 10b5-1 stuff, not a red flag — but the bearish options flow with unusual puts at \$612-\$615 tells me institutions are hedging near-term downside into September.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

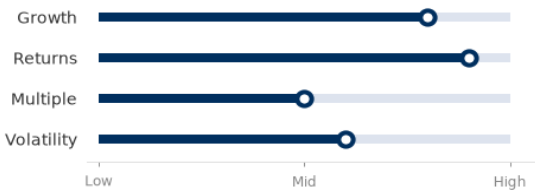
Two policy threads matter right now: First, the Kids Online Safety Act (KOSA) framework is back in Congressional discussion, and the Australian teen account purge is basically META preemptively getting ahead of it — if KOSA passes with teeth, it's a compliance cost headwind but also a moat because smaller platforms can't afford the infrastructure. Second, watch the AI executive orders around data center permitting and power access — the administration has been pro-buildout, which directly helps META's \$60B+ annual capex plan by cutting red tape. Antitrust is the wild card: the FTC's Instagram/WhatsApp divestiture case is still grinding, and any adverse ruling in the next 6 months would be a real gut-punch.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$588.05
12M Price Target	\$720.00
Upside / (Downside)	+22.4%
Market Cap	\$1.50T
FY2026E Revenue	\$202M
FY2027E Revenue	\$232M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	21.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$630.00	\$600.00	\$555.00
6 Months	\$720.00	\$650.00	\$520.00
1 Year	\$800.00	\$720.00	\$500.00
2 Years	\$950.00	\$820.00	\$480.00
5 Years	\$1400.00	\$1050.00	\$550.00
10 Years	\$2200.00	\$1500.00	\$600.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communication Services (+1.09%) and Tech (+0.98% today, +2.91% for the week) are leading — money is flowing back into mega-cap tech after last week's rate scare. Real Estate leading is interesting — likely a bet on data center REITs benefiting from the AI buildout.

COOLING OFF: Financials are lagging (+0.34%), suggesting rate cut expectations are cooling and the "reflation" trade is pausing.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO AI beneficiaries and OUT of defensive rate-sensitive names. The fact that Real Estate and Tech are both up tells you investors are playing the AI infrastructure theme from multiple angles.

RELATED PLAY: If you like META's AI thesis but want less regulatory exposure, look at the data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) or the power infrastructure names (VST, CEG) — they win regardless of which hyperscaler dominates.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GOOGL (Alphabet): Retail's favorite for next 12 months per Stocktwits — search resilience plus Gemini traction, and less regulatory heat than META right now.
- NVDA (Nvidia): The \$6T prediction from Motley Fool is hype, but the underlying signal is real — every dollar META spends on AI capex flows through Nvidia's income statement.

META CONTEXT: META is lagging the mega-cap AI cohort right now, sitting at just 25% of its 52-week range while NVDA and MSFT are near highs. That's either a warning or an opportunity — I lean opportunity because the ad business fundamentals haven't cracked, only sentiment has.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$570-585 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Ad revenue growth drops below 8% YoY or forced AI capex writedown

Hedging: Small put spread ~\$560 or pair with a lower-multiple mega cap like GOOGL

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Hold	\$936.96 ▲ 2.82%	12M Price Target \$1050.00	52-Week Range \$113.46 – \$1255.00	Market Cap N/A
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MU: Riding AI Memory Wave, But Korea Rivals Loom

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU popped nearly 3% to \$937 on the back of two things: strong AI infrastructure earnings from CoreWeave and Supermicro (which means their customers are still buying GPUs — and every GPU needs Micron's high-bandwidth memory), plus a 3.5% overnight rally in Korea's market lifting the whole memory complex.
- But there's a wrinkle — Barron's ran a piece today saying a memory rival (likely SK Hynix or Samsung) is "crushing it," which is why the low volume today (6M vs ~30M normal) suggests traders are hesitant to chase the gap up.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm thinking: MU has ripped from \$113 to \$937 in a year — that's not a stock, that's a rocket. The move today is more about sector momentum than MU-specific news, and the options market is flashing yellow — put/call ratio at 1.35 (meaning traders are buying way more downside protection than upside bets) and some serious institutional puts hitting at \$1250 strike. That tells me smart money thinks the ceiling is close. The bigger picture: AI capex is still accelerating, but Micron is now a "show me" story — they need to prove they can keep taking HBM (high-bandwidth memory, the specialized chips that feed Nvidia GPUs) share from SK Hynix, who's been the dominant player. If they lose an Nvidia allocation slot, this stock gets cut in half fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The CHIPS Act is MU's single biggest political tailwind — they've been awarded roughly \$6.1B in federal subsidies for their Idaho and New York fabs, and the Trump administration has so far kept that money flowing despite earlier threats to renegotiate. Watch for two things: (1) any tariff escalation with China on semiconductors, which would be a mixed bag — hurts MU's China sales (~10% of revenue) but helps them domestically vs. Chinese memory rival CXMT, and (2) the export control review currently in play at Commerce, which could tighten what MU can sell to China. Net-net, the regulatory environment is friendlier to MU than to any foreign competitor right now, and that's a structural moat.

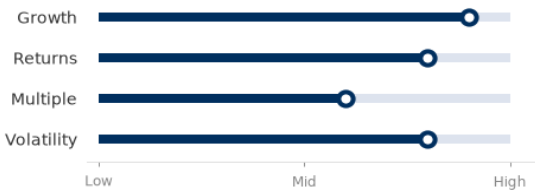
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$937 and roughly 66x forward earnings, investors are paying \$66 for every \$1 of profit MU is expected to make next year — that's very expensive for a company in a historically cyclical industry (memory prices boom and bust every 2-3 years). The bull case says "this cycle is different because AI demand is structural, not cyclical," and there's truth to that — HBM is sold out through 2026. But you're paying growth-stock prices for what has always been a commodity business, so any hint the cycle is peaking will get punished hard.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$936.96
12M Price Target	\$1050.00
Upside / (Downside)	+12.1%
Market Cap	N/A
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$62,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.20
FY2027E EPS	\$19.80
Fwd P/E	66.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1050.00	\$950.00	\$820.00
6 Months	\$1200.00	\$1000.00	\$750.00
1 Year	\$1400.00	\$1050.00	\$700.00
2 Years	\$1800.00	\$1250.00	\$650.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1600.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$4000.00	\$2200.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+2.9% over 5 days) and specifically anything AI infrastructure — CoreWeave/SMCI earnings confirm the capex cycle isn't slowing. Korean semis are on fire, which pulls MU up with them.

COOLING OFF: Financials and defensive sectors are lagging as risk appetite returns; also Michael Burry's "1987 crash" warning is making the tape jumpy on high-flying names.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO AI infrastructure and OUT of defensives — that's a direct tailwind for MU, but it also means MU trades with beta risk (when tech sells off, MU sells off harder).

RELATED PLAY: If you like the memory thesis but want less single-stock risk, SOXX (semiconductor ETF) gives you MU exposure plus the equipment makers (LRCX, AMAT) that sell to Micron — they benefit when MU builds new fabs.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI king; every dollar spent on Nvidia GPUs pulls Micron HBM along with it.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI silicon wins for hyperscalers keep expanding — indirectly bullish for memory demand.

MU CONTEXT: MU is roughly in-line with the semi peer group but lagging pure-play AI names like NVDA and AVGO. That's actually healthy — it means MU hasn't gotten as speculative as some, but it also means it doesn't have the "must-own" narrative premium. The stock is behaving like a high-quality cyclical rather than a pure AI story, which is probably the right way to think about it.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$850-880 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: HBM pricing collapse, Samsung/SK Hynix winning major Nvidia allocation from MU, or CHIPS Act funding clawback

Hedging: Pair with short SOXX or long-dated puts to protect against memory cycle downturn

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold \$332.83 ▲ 1.62% 12M Price Target \$360.00 52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83

Market Cap \$1.31T

TSLA: Robotaxi Stuck, Solar Pivot Raises Eyebrows

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is up 1.6% on light volume (5.2M shares vs usual 25-40M) — that's a low-conviction bounce, not real buying. The news flow is mixed: Chamath is hyping a \$10B solar/nuclear pivot, but Gary Black (a longtime Tesla bull) is publicly asking why the robotaxi fleet is STUCK at 90-100 vehicles months after launch. That's a big deal — the whole AI/autonomy narrative that justifies this valuation depends on scaling that fleet.
- Barron's ran a "why is TSLA struggling" piece — when the mainstream financial press writes that, it usually means sentiment has quietly rolled over even though the stock isn't crashing.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension: TSLA trades at ~155x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$155 for every \$1 of profit — because investors believe robotaxi and AI will explode. But the robotaxi fleet isn't scaling, and now Musk is pivoting attention to a \$10B solar manufacturing bet. That's classic Elon — chase the next shiny thing before proving the last one. The stock is only at 18% of its 52-week range (\$297-\$499), which tells you the market has already been quietly de-rating this. Unless robotaxi meaningfully scales in Q3/Q4 or auto deliveries surprise, there's no catalyst to push it back toward \$450+. The bullish options flow (P/C ratio 0.62) suggests traders are betting on a short-term bounce, not a fundamental re-rating.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang: the \$7,500 federal EV tax credit was killed under the current administration's rollback of Biden-era clean energy incentives, and that directly hurts TSLA's US demand — every Model Y just got effectively \$7,500 more expensive to the buyer. On the flip side, Trump's tariffs on Chinese EVs (100%+) protect Tesla from BYD flooding the US market, which is a real moat. Watch two things: (1) any federal autonomous vehicle framework — a national AV rule would let robotaxi scale beyond the current state-by-state patchwork, and (2) the ongoing CAFE/emissions credit debate — Tesla made \$2.8B last year selling regulatory credits, and if those get gutted, earnings take a real hit.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$333, you're paying about 155x next year's earnings and roughly 12x revenue — that's insane for a company whose core auto business is growing single digits and whose margins are compressing. For context, Toyota trades at ~10x earnings. The only way this valuation makes sense is if you believe robotaxi becomes a real business in the next 2-3 years — and right now, with 90-100 cars on the road, that's a faith-based investment, not a numbers-based one.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

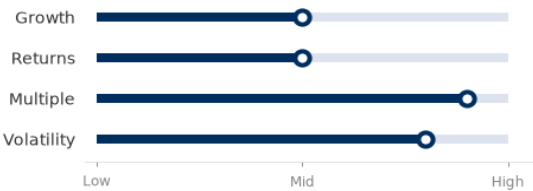
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-13 14:03 UTC

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Key Data

Price (USD)	\$332.83
12M Price Target	\$360.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.2%
Market Cap	\$1.31T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$128M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.10
Fwd P/E	155.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$355.00	\$335.00	\$305.00
6 Months	\$420.00	\$350.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$480.00	\$360.00	\$240.00
2 Years	\$600.00	\$400.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$500.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$1400.00	\$700.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+2.9% on 5 days) and Comm Services are catching a bid — money is flowing into pure AI plays like NVDA, MSFT, GOOGL as earnings season reinforced the AI capex story. Utilities are quietly running (+1.6% 5D) on data center power demand.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (where TSLA lives) isn't in the top movers today — the consumer is stretched, and big-ticket purchases like EVs are getting deferred.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO AI infrastructure and OUT OF consumer-facing AI stories. TSLA is caught in between — it wants to be an AI stock but the market still treats it as a car company on days like today.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI/autonomy story, NVDA (chips powering it) and maybe a play on lithium miners or charging infrastructure gives you exposure without single-CEO risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the cleanest AI play — every hyperscaler capex dollar flows through them, and there's no CEO distraction risk
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Waymo is quietly winning the robotaxi race that TSLA is losing, and you get it essentially for free inside a \$2T company trading at 22x earnings

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is lagging the tech sector's 5-day run (+2.9% for tech vs TSLA basically flat) — that's a tell. When AI names rip and Tesla doesn't come along, the market is telling you it's not being priced as an AI stock right now. That's a warning sign until robotaxi shows real traction.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

5/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 5/10 — I'm neutral here. The valuation is stretched and near-term catalysts are thin, but you can't short Elon lightly — he's created value from thin air before.

POSITION SIZE: Keep it 2-3% max. This isn't a "back up the truck" setup; it's a "have some exposure in case the AI narrative reignites" position.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd rather add at \$300-310 — that's near the 52-week low and gives you a better risk/reward. Chasing \$333 on 5M shares of volume feels premature.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months, waiting for the robotaxi fleet to either scale to 1,000+ vehicles (bullish confirmation) or stall (get out).

WHEN TO BAIL: If Q3 auto margins drop below 15%, if robotaxi is still under 200 vehicles by December, or if Musk announces another major distraction (buying another company, new startup, etc.).

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a put option 10% below current price expiring in 3-4 months. Think of it like insurance: costs you a small premium, but if the stock craters on bad delivery numbers, your losses are capped.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$225.41 ▲ 0.59%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.46T
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NVDA: AI Capex Cycle Getting a Wall Street Assist

WHAT HAPPENED

- Big story: NVDA is teaming up with Goldman Sachs and BlackRock to help *finance* the AI data center buildout. Translation — Wall Street is now underwriting the demand for NVDA's own chips. That's a huge deal because the #1 pushback on NVDA is "who's actually paying for all this AI infrastructure?" Now Goldman and BlackRock are basically answering that question with a checkbook.
- CoreWeave and Nebius (both huge NVDA customers) ripped higher on strong AI spending numbers — that's a direct read-through that NVDA's order book stays fat into 2027.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Goldman/BlackRock financing partnership is more important than it looks — it essentially creates a vendor-financing flywheel where NVDA helps arrange capital for the buyers of its own GPUs. That's the same playbook Cisco used in the late '90s dot-com boom, which is both the bull case (extends the cycle) AND the risk (concentrates counterparty exposure). Near-term though, this signals the AI capex cycle isn't slowing — it's getting institutionalized. With Trump's budget deficit ballooning to \$432B in July and new tax cuts on the table, expect continued loose fiscal conditions that keep risk assets (and AI names) bid.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to watch: (1) the Trump administration's China chip export policy — there's an ongoing negotiation where NVDA agreed to give the US government a 15% cut of H20 chip sales to China in exchange for export licenses. If that framework holds, it unlocks billions in Chinese revenue that was previously frozen. (2) The proposed new tax cuts being floated would likely include accelerated depreciation for data center capex — that's a direct subsidy for NVDA's customers to buy more chips. Both are tailwinds if they land.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$5.46T market cap, NVDA trades around 46x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$46 today for every \$1 of profit expected next year. That's expensive vs the S&P at ~22x, but cheap vs where NVDA traded a year ago (60x+) because earnings have caught up to the stock price. If FY27 revenue hits \$265B as I model, this is actually reasonable — the question isn't valuation, it's whether the AI capex cycle keeps humming.

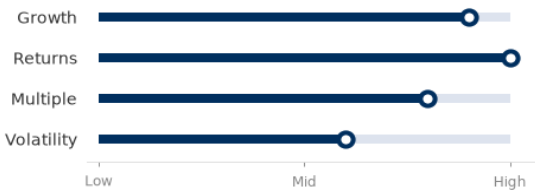
WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- China export policy reversal — if Trump uses NVDA chips as a bargaining chip in trade talks and tightens restrictions, that's a \$15-20B revenue hit

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$225.41
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.3%
Market Cap	\$5.46T
FY2026E Revenue	\$205M
FY2027E Revenue	\$265M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.85
FY2027E EPS	\$6.40
Fwd P/E	46.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$245.00	\$230.00	\$210.00
6 Months	\$275.00	\$250.00	\$200.00
1 Year	\$310.00	\$260.00	\$185.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$300.00	\$170.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$400.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$250.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+2.9% over 5 days) and Comm Services are leading — that's classic risk-on behavior tied to expectations of more Trump tax cuts and continued AI spending. Real Estate popping today is interesting — likely rate-cut expectations building on the weak household debt data.

COOLING OFF: Financials lagging (+0.5% on 5D) despite the AI financing news — banks aren't getting credit for the AI boom yet, which might be an opportunity.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is staying in AI/tech rather than rotating out — the CoreWeave/Nebius rip today shows the "picks and shovels" trade still has legs. No sign of the AI rotation ending.

RELATED PLAY: If NVDA's financing partnership works, data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) and power infrastructure names (VST, CEG) are the second-order winners — they physically house and power the GPUs.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- CRWV (CoreWeave): Ripped on strong AI spending report — proves customer demand for NVDA silicon is accelerating, not slowing
- NBIS (Nebius): Same story — GPU cloud providers seeing massive demand, which means they're placing bigger NVDA orders

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is up only 0.6% while its customers are soaring — that's a lag worth noting. Usually when customers rip, NVDA follows within a week. This looks like a coiled spring setup unless the unusual put activity is signaling something we don't know.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — The AI capex cycle keeps finding new legs (now with Wall Street financing), and I don't see the catalyst that breaks it in the next 6 months.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a 20% drawdown doesn't ruin your year. This isn't a "bet the farm" name at \$5.5T market cap anymore.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$215-220 (recent support). If it breaks \$210, wait — that would signal something changed.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is FY27 revenue guidance confirming the \$260B+ run-rate. That's when the "AI is peaking" narrative dies for good.

WHEN TO BAIL: If a top-3 hyperscaler cuts capex guidance, or China exports get fully re-banned, or the stock breaks \$200 on high volume — those are my three exit triggers.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is buying a small put position (like \$200 strike puts 3 months out) as insurance — think of it as paying 1-2% of your position as an "insurance premium" against a nasty drawdown.

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$345.29 ▲ 0.51%	12M Price Target \$390.00	52-Week Range \$196.60 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.22T
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GOOGL: Gemini Momentum Outshines Pixel, AI Spend Debate Heats Up

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock bounced modestly (+0.51%) after a nasty two-day slide from \$357 to \$343 — that drop was driven by "AI capex fatigue" (basically, funds getting nervous Alphabet is spending too much on data centers and chips). The bounce today lines up with a Motley Fool piece arguing GOOGL is a cheaper way to own the Anthropic story (Google owns a big Anthropic stake), which is reframing the spending debate as an asset play, not just a cost.
- Pixel 11 launched but nobody cares — the real signal is Gemini AI integration everywhere. That matters because it shows Google is monetizing AI through distribution it already owns, versus OpenAI which has to buy its way in.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Steve Eisman warning that "the AI boom depends on OpenAI and Anthropic" is actually a backdoor bull case for GOOGL — Alphabet owns ~14% of Anthropic and has its own frontier model, meaning it wins whether the ecosystem consolidates around 2 players or fragments. The insider selling looks scary at first glance, but the Sergey Brin transactions marked at \$0 are almost certainly gifts or trust transfers (not open-market sales) — don't read that as a signal. The bullish options flow (put/call of 0.63, meaning traders are buying 63 puts for every 100 calls — heavy call skew) alongside unusual call buying at \$315-\$302 strikes suggests smart money is treating this \$343 level as a floor, not a ceiling. Bottom line: the market is finally starting to give Alphabet credit for being the only Big Tech name that owns the full AI stack, and the recent dip looks like a gift.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

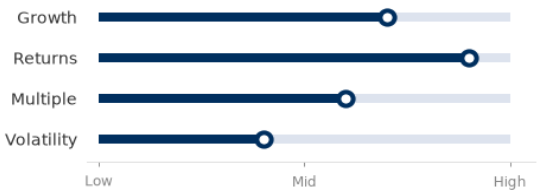
The big overhang is the DOJ antitrust remedy phase — the search monopoly ruling is still working through remedies, with the risk being forced divestiture of Chrome or Android (unlikely but not zero). On the tailwind side, the current administration's AI executive framework has leaned toward "American AI dominance" over heavy regulation, which favors scale players like GOOGL over startups needing compliance budgets. Also watch the ongoing debate over Section 230 reform and AI-generated content liability — if Congress carves out safe harbors for AI outputs (which is being discussed in the Senate Commerce Committee), that removes a major legal cloud over Gemini in Search.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$345.29
12M Price Target	\$390.00
Upside / (Downside)	+12.9%
Market Cap	\$4.22T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$10.20
FY2027E EPS	\$11.85
Fwd P/E	33.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$350.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$375.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$440.00	\$390.00	\$295.00
2 Years	\$520.00	\$440.00	\$280.00
5 Years	\$750.00	\$600.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1200.00	\$850.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communication Services (+1.09%) and Tech (+0.98%, +2.91% over 5 days) — money is flowing back into mega-cap AI winners after last week's mini-rotation into defensives. Real Estate leading is likely a rates-down signal, which is also good for growth multiples.

COOLING OFF: Financials lagging (+0.34%) suggests the market isn't buying a re-acceleration narrative — it's a "AI winners get bid, everything else drifts" tape.

ROTATION WATCH: Capital is rotating out of speculative small-cap AI and into the profitable hyperscalers (GOOGL, MSFT, META) — investors want AI exposure with actual cash flow behind it.

RELATED PLAY: If GOOGL's cloud story keeps working, the picks-and-shovels plays are data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) and power infrastructure names — they benefit whether GOOGL or MSFT wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- META (Meta Platforms): Riding the same Comm Services wave, benefiting from AI ad-targeting improvements and lack of DOJ overhang.
- MSFT (Microsoft): OpenAI partnership narrative still working, Azure AI revenue accelerating.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL has been lagging MSFT and META over the past week because of the capex concerns — but that's exactly why it's the more interesting setup here. When lagging quality mega-caps catch up, they tend to do so quickly. The fact that GOOGL is at 70% of its 52-week range while peers are near highs means there's more room to run if sentiment turns.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$335-345 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Gemini share loss vs. OpenAI/Anthropic, DOJ forced Chrome/Android divestiture, or capex ROI clearly failing

Hedging: Long-dated puts or pair against an overvalued AI pure-play like a richly-priced Anthropic-adjacent name

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy

\$227.70 ▲ 4.89%

12M Price Target
\$275.00

52-Week Range
\$61.44 – \$329.88

Market Cap
\$204.37B

MRVL: AI Chip Momentum Builds Into Earnings Print

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock ripped +4.9% on light volume (only 3.2M shares vs 20M+ recent days) — that's a "melt-up" pattern, meaning buyers are chasing but sellers stepped aside. The Barchart piece flagging a "quick bounce before earnings" is likely fueling positioning ahead of MRVL's late-August print.
- The whole semi complex is heating up — the "3 Semi Stocks to Buy Before AI Earnings Wave" narrative is pulling money into the space, and Tech ETF is up +2.9% over 5 days leading the market.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension nobody's talking about: the stock is ripping, but the options market is flashing bearish (put/call ratio of 1.52 means traders are buying 52% more downside protection than upside bets). Someone dropped nearly \$1M on \$275 puts expiring September — that's a sophisticated player betting the earnings pop fades. Translation: smart money thinks this pre-earnings rally is a "sell the news" setup, not the start of a new leg higher. That said, with 96.5% institutional ownership and Fidelity holding 15%, the big boys aren't running for the exits — they're just hedging their winners, which is normal behavior when a stock has quintupled off its 52-week low of \$61.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The CHIPS Act tailwind is still very much alive — Marvell benefits both directly (they've received federal funding for advanced packaging) and indirectly through customers like AWS and Microsoft building US-based AI infrastructure. Watch two things: (1) any new export controls on advanced chips to China — MRVL has meaningful China exposure and further restrictions would compress the addressable market, and (2) the ongoing debate over AI infrastructure tax credits, which if expanded would juice hyperscaler capex (Marvell's biggest customer group). Net-net: the policy environment for domestic AI silicon is friendlier than it's been in decades, which is why the stock trades at these premium multiples.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$227 with a \$204B market cap, investors are paying roughly \$25 for every \$1 of expected revenue — that's expensive by any historical measure, but the AI custom silicon story justifies premium pricing. On forward earnings, you're paying about 83x — meaning it takes 83 years of current profits to earn back your investment, which only makes sense if you believe earnings grow 40%+ annually. Compared to Broadcom (which Zacks just called overvalued at 23.8x P/E — literally a quarter of MRVL's multiple), Marvell is priced for flawless execution.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

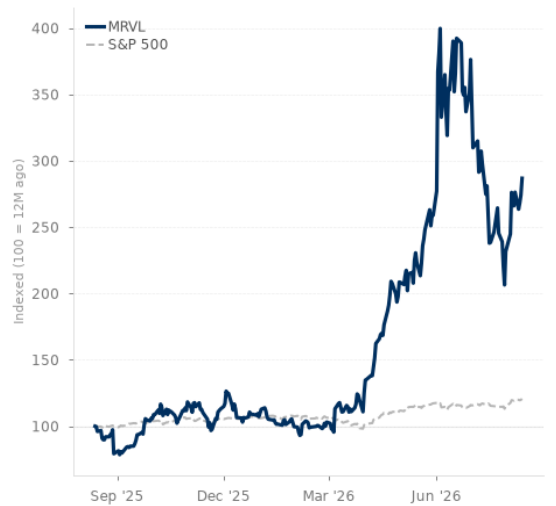
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$227.70
12M Price Target	\$275.00
Upside / (Downside)	+20.8%
Market Cap	\$204.37B
FY2026E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.75
FY2027E EPS	\$3.90
Fwd P/E	82.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$260.00	\$235.00	\$200.00
6 Months	\$300.00	\$260.00	\$190.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$275.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$420.00	\$320.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$425.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+2.9% over 5 days) is leading, driven by AI earnings anticipation and continued hyperscaler capex commitments. Communication Services also strong as ad-tech and cloud narratives reinforce each other.

COOLING OFF: Nothing catastrophically weak today, but defensive sectors (Utilities, Staples) lagging suggests risk-on mode is fully engaged — which historically precedes volatility spikes.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating aggressively into AI-adjacent semis ahead of the August/September earnings wave — MRVL, AVGO, ALAB all catching bids. This is a crowded trade, meaning when it unwinds, it unwinds fast.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI infrastructure buildout continues, the picks-and-shovels play is data center power/cooling (think Vertiv or Eaton) — they benefit no matter which chip designer wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- ALAB (Astera Labs): Riding the PCIe connectivity boom — Zacks flagged them as benefiting from the same AI interconnect trend that helps Marvell.
- NVDA (Nvidia): The \$10 trillion market cap chatter is pulling the entire semi complex higher on sentiment alone.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL is participating in the rally but not leading it — it's up 4.9% today while the sector is only up 1%. That's a pre-earnings positioning move, not fundamental leadership. Still trading at 69% of its 52-week high, so there's room to run IF earnings deliver.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Bullish on the long-term AI silicon story, but the near-term setup with bearish options flow into earnings makes me cautious about chasing here.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — real upside but real earnings volatility means you don't want to be oversized when they report.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to \$205-215 (which is where we were 3 days ago) rather than chase this pop. If earnings disappoint, \$180-190 is your dream entry.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the AI custom silicon revenue ramp is a 2026-2028 story, not a one-quarter trade.

WHEN TO BAIL: If they lose a major hyperscaler customer, if AI capex guidance from AWS/Microsoft/Google turns lower, or if the stock breaks \$180 on heavy volume.

HEDGING: If you're long, consider buying protective puts around the earnings date — think of it as insurance premium against a bad print. Alternatively, pair with a short position in an even more expensive AI name to isolate MRVL's specific bet.

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.9/10	BUY	
Price: \$141.71 · 1M: +33.0% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$17.8B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
2	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.9/10	BUY	
Price: \$39.74 · 1M: +43.7% · P/S: 0.7x · Cap: \$25.7B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$52 entry					
3	MDB	MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.5/10	BUY	
Price: \$457.46 · 1M: +35.3% · P/S: 14.1x · Cap: \$36.8B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
4	AVAV	AeroVironment, Inc. Defense Technology	8.2/10	BUY	
Price: \$190.17 · 1M: +34.1% · P/S: 4.9x · Cap: \$9.6B			OPT:NEUT	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
5	GTLB	GitLab Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.2/10	BUY	
Price: \$41.17 · 1M: +23.0% · P/S: 6.9x · Cap: \$7.0B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$48 entry					